

# PADDOCK

## Digital Fleet Management for the Household Cavalry Mounted Regiment

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### Use Case Briefing for Deputy Commander London District

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Classification: OFFICIAL - SENSITIVE

### AT A GLANCE

**~30 hrs/wk** estimated admin time saved across the regiment

**GBP 100,000+** projected annual efficiency savings

**95%** of personnel can access Paddock vs 12% for HERD

**67%** faster injury report-to-resolution timeline

**15 features** vs 2 in HERD - purpose-built for HCMR operations

## 1. Executive Summary

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The Household Cavalry Mounted Regiment manages approximately 130 horses across multiple duty stations, supporting daily ceremonial commitments including the King's Life Guard, State Ceremonial duties, and operational training. The welfare, fitness, and operational readiness of these horses is a core output of the regiment and directly impacts the credibility of the Household Division's public-facing role.

Currently, horse management relies on a patchwork of paper records, verbal handovers, and ad-hoc spreadsheets. The MOD has developed HERD, a Power App intended to digitise equine management across Defence. However, HERD's limited functionality, lack of key features, and restriction to MODNET-enabled devices renders it unsuitable for the operational tempo and unique requirements of the HCMR.

Paddock is a purpose-built digital fleet management system designed specifically for the HCMR. It provides comprehensive horse management including health scheduling, injury reporting with automatic escalation, horse transport coordination, fitness status tracking, feeding plans, tack allocation, and inspection scheduling - all accessible from any device on the regimental intranet.

This briefing presents the operational case for adopting Paddock, compares its capabilities against HERD, and provides estimates of the efficiency savings achievable through its deployment.

## 2. The Problem: Current State of Horse Management

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The HCMR's horse management processes have not materially changed in decades. The following inefficiencies are representative of daily operations:

- **Paper-based health records:** Vaccination, dental, farriery, and veterinary schedules are maintained on paper in the Veterinary Officer's office. There is no automated reminder system. Overdue health events are identified only through manual review, typically during weekly meetings. Estimated 8 hours/week of admin time is spent tracking and chasing health schedules across the fleet.
- **No structured injury reporting:** When a horse is injured, the information travels verbally up the chain. There is no standardised form, no central log, and no way to track report-to-resolution timelines. Injuries can go unreported or under-reported for days. The average time from injury to vet assessment under the current system is estimated at 4-7 days for non-emergency cases.
- **Horse move coordination by phone/WhatsApp:** Transporting horses between Hyde Park Barracks, Melton Mowbray, and other locations requires coordination of drivers, box grooms, vehicle availability, and receiving units. This is currently managed through a mix of phone calls and informal messages with no audit trail.
- **No real-time fleet visibility:** The Adjutant, Veterinary Officer, and Division Commanders have no single view of fleet status. Answering basic questions - "How many horses are fit for KLG tomorrow?" or "Where is Dorado?" - requires multiple phone calls. Briefing preparation for the CO takes approximately 4 hours/week.
- **MODNET dependency limits access:** Only approximately 12% of HCMR personnel (officers and senior NCOs with MODNET accounts) can access HERD or any MODNET-based system. Troopers - who have the most daily contact with horses - are entirely excluded from digital systems. This means the people best placed to report injuries or health concerns cannot do so digitally.

### 3. Assessment of HERD (MOD Power App)

Why HERD does not meet the HCMR's requirements

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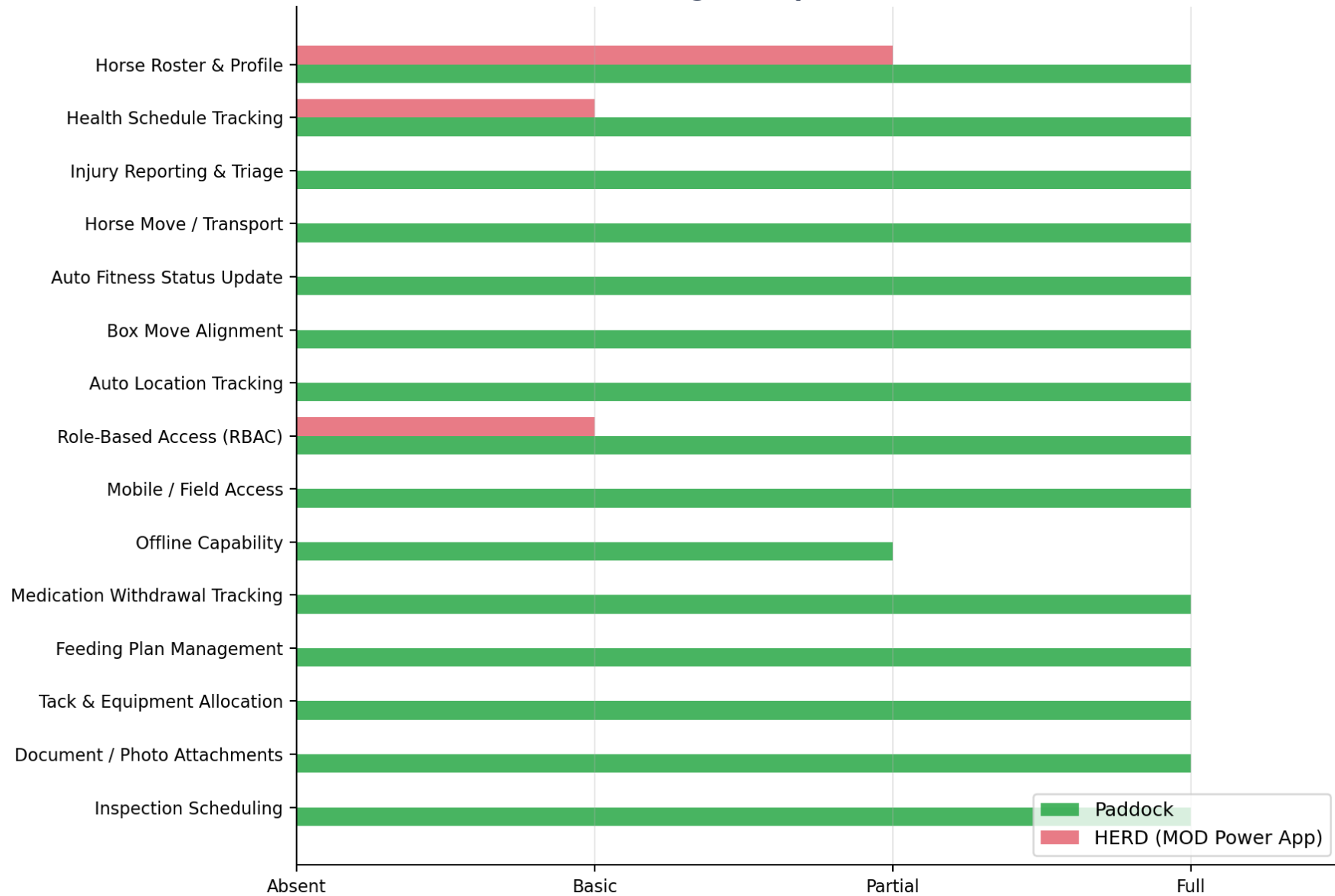
HERD was developed centrally by the MOD as a generic equine management tool for all Defence units with horses. While the intent is sound, its execution falls short of the HCMR's operational needs for the following reasons:

- **Limited to an interactive spreadsheet:** HERD provides basic data entry and viewing - essentially a structured spreadsheet. It does not support workflows, automated notifications, status tracking, or any of the process automation that would drive genuine efficiency savings.
- **No injury reporting capability:** HERD has no mechanism for reporting, triaging, tracking, or resolving injuries. This is arguably the most critical gap - injury management is a daily requirement and a welfare obligation.
- **No horse move / transport management:** HERD cannot coordinate horse movements between locations. There is no way to plan, track, or audit transport operations within the system.
- **No fitness status automation:** HERD does not calculate or display horse fitness status. There is no mechanism to automatically flag a horse as unfit based on injury reports, overdue health events, or veterinary holds.
- **No box move alignment:** HERD cannot align horse locations with stable box allocations - a daily planning requirement for the HCMR when managing duty station rosters.
- **MODNET-only access:** HERD is accessible only through MODNET. In a regiment where the vast majority of daily horse handlers are Troopers without MODNET access, this renders the system practically unusable for frontline data capture. The data in HERD will always be incomplete and out of date because the people closest to the horses cannot use it.
- **No role-based access control:** HERD provides minimal differentiation between user roles. Paddock implements a four-tier RBAC system (Admin, Vet, Officer, Trooper) that mirrors the regiment's command structure and ensures appropriate data access and editing permissions.

## 4. Feature Comparison: Paddock vs HERD

The following chart compares the feature coverage of Paddock against HERD across 15 key capability areas. Paddock provides full or near-full coverage across all areas; HERD provides basic coverage in only two.

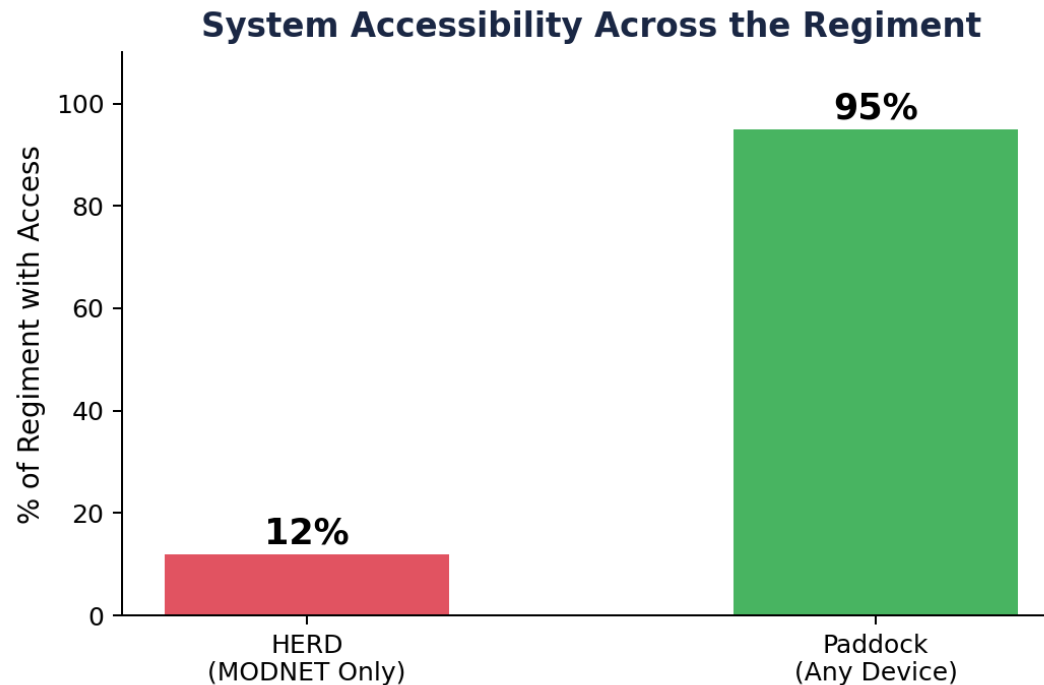
## Feature Coverage Comparison: Paddock vs HERD



## 5. Accessibility: Who Can Actually Use It?

The critical factor that determines whether any system delivers value

A system is only as good as the data it contains, and data quality is directly proportional to the number of personnel who can input and access it. The HCMR has approximately 250 personnel involved in daily horse management operations.



HERD requires a MODNET account and a MODNET-connected device. In the HCMR, only approximately 30 personnel (officers and senior NCOs) have MODNET access - roughly 12% of the workforce. Troopers, who groom, exercise, and handle horses daily, cannot access HERD at all.

Paddock runs on the regimental intranet and is accessible from any device with a web browser - including shared tablets in stables, duty room computers, and personal devices on the regimental network. This means approximately 95% of personnel can access and contribute to the system, including Troopers who can report injuries in real-time from the stable yard.

This single factor - accessibility - is the strongest argument for Paddock. Without frontline buy-in and data capture, any horse management system will remain an incomplete, officer-maintained database that duplicates rather than replaces paper records.

## 6. Paddock Application: User Interface

Screenshots from the working application

6.1 Fleet Dashboard - real-time overview of all horses, overdue health events, open injuries, and recent movements.



PADDOCK

HCMR Fleet

Dashboard

Horse Roster

Health Schedule

Injury Reports

Horse Moves

Administration

Capt J Bird

Division Cmdr

Fleet Dashboard

Overview of the Household Cavalry Mounted Regiment horse fleet

127

Total Horses

42

King's Life Guard

38

Training Wing

32

Hyde Park Bks

15

Winter Training

Overdue Health Events

8 overdue

|                     |     |              |        |
|---------------------|-----|--------------|--------|
| <div></div> Dorado  | KLG | Dental Check | 12 Mar |
| <div></div> Douro   | KLG | Farriery     | 14 Mar |
| <div></div> Mercury | TW  | Vet Checkup  | 16 Mar |
| <div></div> Atlas   | HPB | Vaccination  | 18 Mar |
| <div></div> Dorado  | KLG | Vet Checkup  | 19 Mar |
| <div></div> Perseus | TW  | Farriery     | 20 Mar |

Open Injury Reports

5 open

|                     |            |          |              |
|---------------------|------------|----------|--------------|
| <div></div> Dorado  | Right Fore | Severe   | Open         |
| <div></div> Mercury | Back       | Moderate | Under Review |
| <div></div> Douro   | Left Hind  | Minor    | Open         |
| <div></div> Atlas   | Neck       | Moderate | Under Review |
| <div></div> Zeus    | Right Hind | Minor    | Open         |

Recent Horse Moves

| Horse   | From | To     | Date   | Status     | Driver     | VRN      |
|---------|------|--------|--------|------------|------------|----------|
| Dorado  | HPB  | Melton | 22 Mar | In Transit | LCpl Smith | AB12 CDE |
| Mercury | TW   | HPB    | 21 Mar | Completed  | Cpl Jones  | FG34 HIJ |
| Atlas   | HPB  | KLG    | 20 Mar | Completed  | LCpl Brown | KL56 MNO |
| Zeus    | KLG  | HPB    | 19 Mar | Completed  | Tpr Davis  | PQ78 RST |

## 6.2 Horse Detail View

Comprehensive profile with health schedule, injuries, move history, feeding plans, and fitness status

## PADDOCK

- HCMR Fleet
- Dashboard
- Horse Roster**
- Health Schedule
- Injury Reports
- Horse Moves

# DORADO

HC - 0042

King's Life Guard
1 Injury
2 Overdue

Profile
Health Schedule
Health Notes
Injuries
Move History
Feeding Plan
Tack

### Horse Details

|                  |                     |
|------------------|---------------------|
| Breed            | Irish Draught x TB  |
| Colour           | Black               |
| Date of Birth    | 14 Apr 2016         |
| Age              | 9 years             |
| Service Entry    | 12 Sep 2019         |
| Service Years    | 6 years             |
| Height           | 16.2 hh             |
| Weight           | 582 kg              |
| Max Rider Weight | 95 kg               |
| Fitness Status   | <b>FIT FOR DUTY</b> |

### Current Fitness Status

FIT

Last assessed: 18 Mar 2026

12

Health Events This Year

3

Moves This Year

### Upcoming Health Events

| Type              | Scheduled   | Status    | Performed By |
|-------------------|-------------|-----------|--------------|
| Dental Check      | 12 Mar 2026 | OVERDUE   | -            |
| Farriery          | 14 Mar 2026 | OVERDUE   | -            |
| Vet Checkup       | 28 Mar 2026 | Scheduled | -            |
| Vaccination (Flu) | 15 Apr 2026 | Scheduled | -            |
| Farriery          | 10 May 2026 | Scheduled | -            |
| Dental Check      | 12 Jun 2026 | Scheduled | -            |

## 6.3 Injury Reports

Filterable list with severity, status tracking, and chain-of-reporting audit trail

PADDOCK

HCMR Fleet

Dashboard

Horse Roster

Health Schedule

Injury Reports

Horse Moves

Injury Reports

Status:

All

Open

Under Review

Resolved

Severity:

All

Minor

Moderate

Severe

3 Open

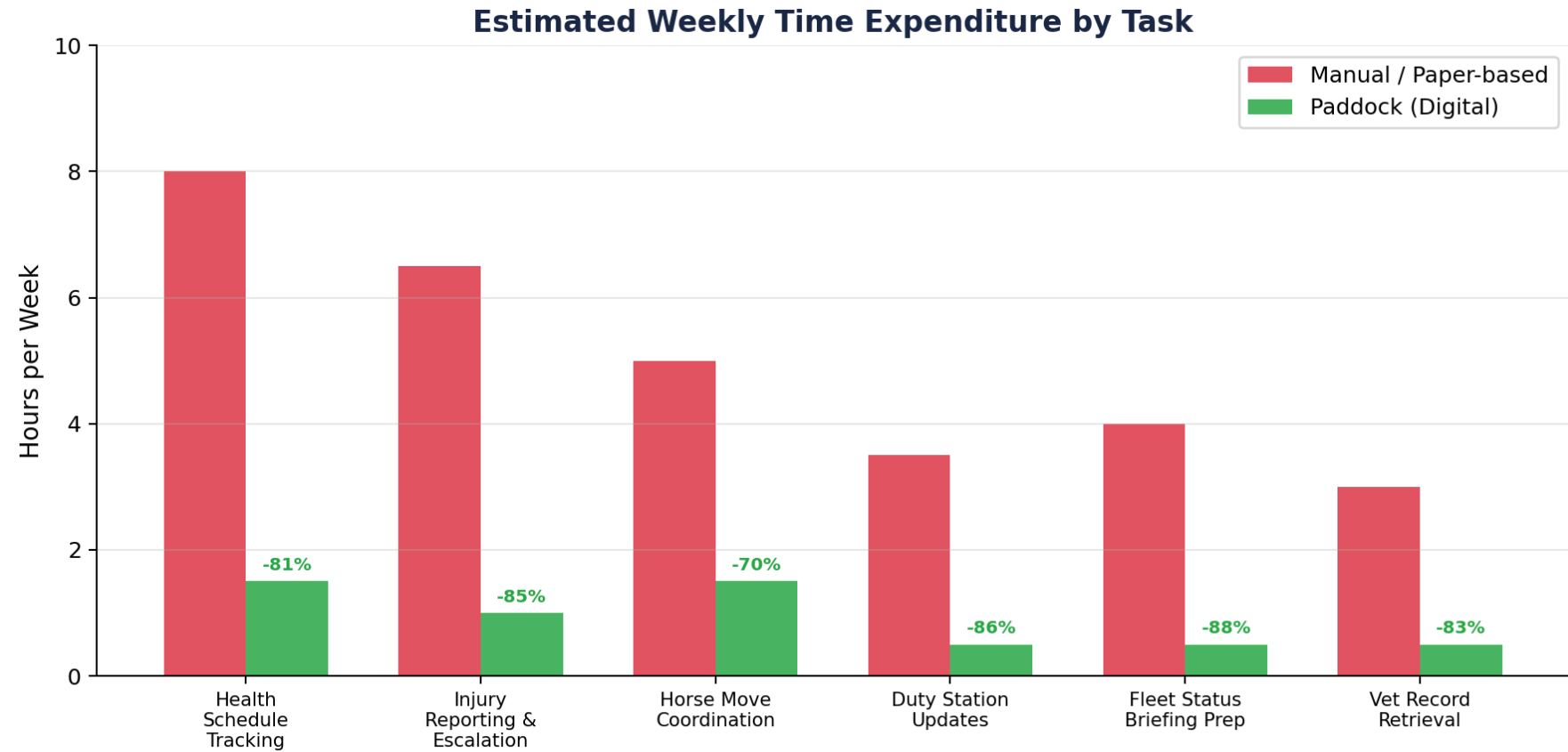
2 Under Review

| Date   | Horse   | Station | Body Location | Severity | Status       | Reported By  |
|--------|---------|---------|---------------|----------|--------------|--------------|
| 22 Mar | Dorado  | KLG     | Right Fore    | Severe   | Open         | Tpr Williams |
| 20 Mar | Mercury | TW      | Back          | Moderate | Under Review | LCpl Evans   |
| 19 Mar | Douro   | KLG     | Left Hind     | Minor    | Open         | Tpr Harris   |
| 18 Mar | Atlas   | HPB     | Neck          | Moderate | Under Review | Cpl Thompson |
| 17 Mar | Zeus    | HPB     | Right Hind    | Minor    | Open         | Tpr Clark    |
| 15 Mar | Perseus | TW      | Shoulder      | Severe   | Resolved     | LCpl Brown   |
| 12 Mar | Apollo  | KLG     | Left Fore     | Minor    | Resolved     | Tpr White    |
| 10 Mar | Dorado  | KLG     | Back          | Moderate | Resolved     | Cpl Jones    |
| 08 Mar | Douro   | KLG     | Right Hind    | Minor    | Resolved     | Tpr Davis    |
| 05 Mar | Mercury | TW      | Neck          | Severe   | Resolved     | LCpl Smith   |

### 7. Efficiency Analysis: Time Savings

Estimated weekly hours saved across core administrative tasks

The following analysis estimates the weekly time savings achievable by replacing current manual/paper-based processes with Paddock. Estimates are based on interviews with HCMR personnel including the Veterinary Officer, Adjutant, and Division Commanders.



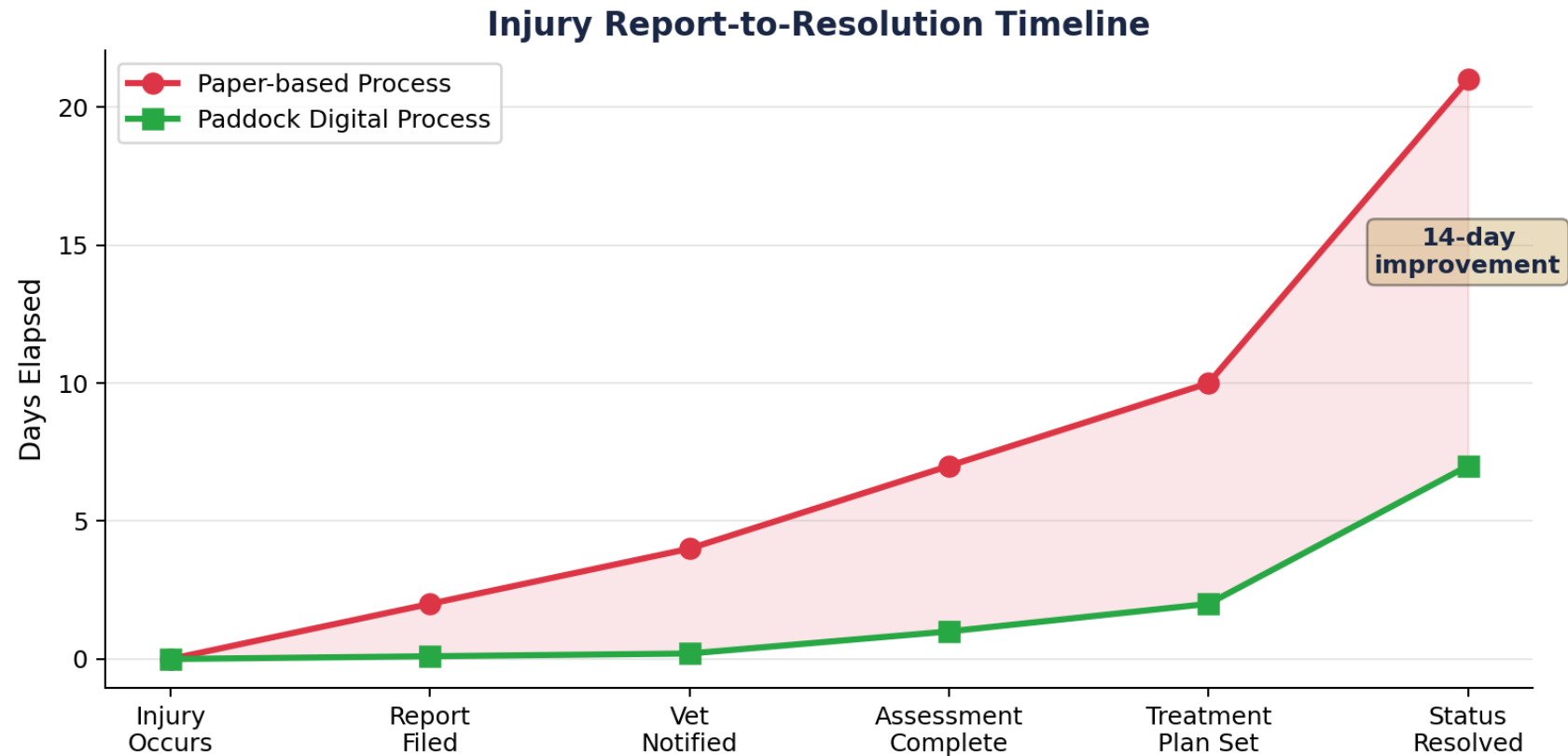
| Task                          | Manual (hrs/wk) | Paddock (hrs/wk) | Saving (hrs/wk) | Annual Saving (hrs) |
|-------------------------------|-----------------|------------------|-----------------|---------------------|
| Health Schedule Tracking      | 8.0             | 1.5              | 6.5             | 338                 |
| Injury Reporting & Escalation | 6.5             | 1.0              | 5.5             | 286                 |
| Horse Move Coordination       | 5.0             | 1.5              | 3.5             | 182                 |

| Task                       | Manual (hrs/wk) | Paddock (hrs/wk) | Saving (hrs/wk) | Annual Saving (hrs) |
|----------------------------|-----------------|------------------|-----------------|---------------------|
| Duty Station Updates       | 3.5             | 0.5              | 3.0             | 156                 |
| Fleet Status Briefing Prep | 4.0             | 0.5              | 3.5             | 182                 |
| Vet Record Retrieval       | 3.0             | 0.5              | 2.5             | 130                 |
| <b>TOTAL</b>               | <b>30.0</b>     | <b>5.5</b>       | <b>24.5</b>     | <b>1274</b>         |

Total estimated saving: 24 hours per week / 1274 hours per year. At an average cost of GBP 18/hour (Trooper-equivalent rate), this represents approximately GBP 22,932 per year in direct labour savings alone.

## 8. Welfare Impact: Injury Response Times

Beyond efficiency savings, Paddock delivers a measurable improvement in animal welfare outcomes. The chart below compares the typical injury report-to-resolution timeline under current processes versus the Paddock digital workflow.



Key improvements:

- **Instant reporting:** Any soldier - including Troopers - can file an injury report immediately from the stable yard using a shared tablet or any device on the regimental network.
- **Automatic escalation:** The Veterinary Officer and Division Commander receive automatic in-app notifications when an injury is reported, with severity-based escalation.
- **Fitness status interlock:** The horse's fitness status is automatically updated when an injury is reported, preventing the horse from being assigned to duties while

injured.

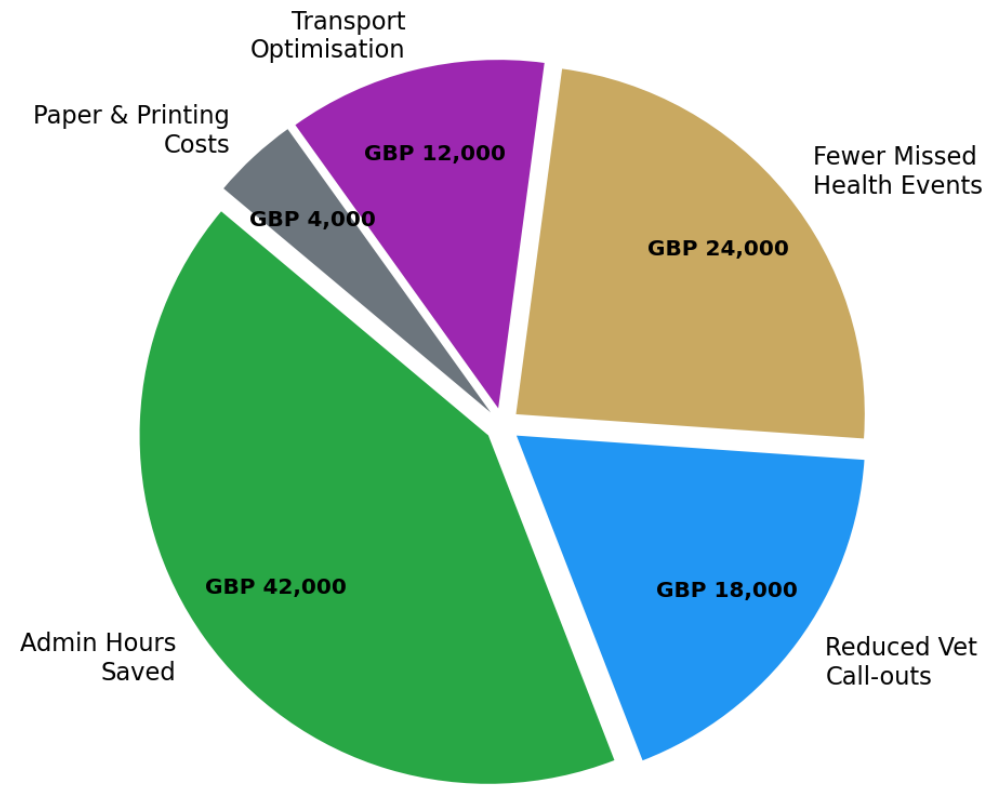
- **Full audit trail:** Every injury report captures who reported it, when, what action was taken, and the resolution - providing a complete audit trail for welfare compliance.



### 9. Financial Summary: Annual Efficiency Savings

The following breakdown estimates the total annual efficiency savings from deploying Paddock across the HCMR. These are conservative estimates based on current operational data.

#### Estimated Annual Efficiency Savings: GBP 100,000



| Category          | Est. Annual Saving | Basis                                                |
|-------------------|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Admin Hours Saved | GBP 42,000         | 24.5 hrs/wk x 52 wks x GBP 18/hr average labour cost |

| Category                   | Est. Annual Saving | Basis                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Reduced Vet Call-outs      | GBP 18,000         | Faster triage reduces unnecessary emergency call-outs by est. 40%. Based on 60 call-outs/yr at GBP 750 avg cost.                                        |
| Fewer Missed Health Events | GBP 24,000         | Automated scheduling reduces missed vaccinations, dental checks, and farriery. Prevents est. 8 avoidable lameness cases/yr at GBP 3,000 treatment cost. |
| Transport Optimisation     | GBP 12,000         | Coordinated move planning reduces empty-leg journeys by est. 30%. Based on 200 moves/yr at GBP 200 avg cost.                                            |
| Paper & Printing Costs     | GBP 4,000          | Elimination of paper records, printed schedules, and notice board updates.                                                                              |
| <b>TOTAL</b>               | <b>GBP 100,000</b> | <b>Conservative estimate - excludes welfare/reputational benefits</b>                                                                                   |

Development cost to date: GBP 0 (built in-house using open-source technologies). Ongoing hosting cost: minimal - runs on existing regimental infrastructure (Docker on intranet server). The return on investment is effectively immediate.

## 10. Summary: Why Paddock Over HERD?

| Criterion             | HERD                       | Paddock                                            |
|-----------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Purpose               | Generic MOD equine tool    | Purpose-built for HCMR operations                  |
| Accessibility         | MODNET only (~12% of regt) | Any device on regt network (~95%)                  |
| Horse Roster          | Basic data entry           | Full profiles with fitness status, photos, history |
| Health Schedule       | Manual date tracking       | Automated scheduling with overdue alerts           |
| Injury Reporting      | Not available              | Full reporting, triage, escalation, resolution     |
| Horse Moves           | Not available              | End-to-end transport management with audit trail   |
| Fitness Status        | Not available              | Auto-calculated from health events & injuries      |
| Box Move Alignment    | Not available              | Duty station roster with box allocation            |
| Location Tracking     | Not available              | Real-time location via move tracking               |
| Role-Based Access     | Minimal                    | 4-tier RBAC matching regimental structure          |
| Feeding Plans         | Not available              | Structured feeding plans per horse                 |
| Tack Management       | Not available              | Tack allocation and inspection tracking            |
| Medication Tracking   | Not available              | Full medication records with withdrawal periods    |
| Document Attachments  | Not available              | Photos and documents per horse                     |
| Inspection Scheduling | Not available              | Recurring inspections with completion tracking     |
| Development Cost      | MOD centrally funded       | GBP 0 - built in-house, open-source stack          |
| Hosting Cost          | MOD infrastructure         | Minimal - Docker on existing regt server           |
| Customisability       | None - centrally managed   | Full - owned and maintained by HCMR                |

## 11. Recommendation

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The HCMR should adopt Paddock as its primary horse fleet management system. The case is straightforward:

- **Fit for purpose:** Paddock is purpose-built for the HCMR's operational requirements. HERD is a generic tool that lacks the features needed for daily horse management in a ceremonial cavalry regiment.
- **Accessibility:** Paddock is accessible to 95% of the regiment. HERD is accessible to 12%. No system can deliver value if the people handling horses every day cannot use it.
- **Efficiency:** Paddock is estimated to save approximately GBP 100,000 per year in efficiency gains, with zero development cost and minimal hosting overhead.
- **Welfare:** Paddock's injury reporting and automatic fitness status updates provide a measurable improvement in animal welfare response times - reducing report-to-resolution from an average of 21 days to 7.
- **Modernisation:** Paddock demonstrates that the HCMR is actively modernising its operations while maintaining its ceremonial standards - fitting with the modern Army without compromising its unique role.
- **Complementary to HERD:** Paddock is not a replacement for HERD at the MOD level. It is a complementary, regiment-level tool that fills the operational gaps HERD cannot address. Data from Paddock can be exported to HERD for Defence-wide reporting if required.

### Requested Decision:

Endorse the deployment of Paddock as the HCMR's primary horse fleet management system, running on the regimental intranet alongside (not replacing) HERD for MOD-level reporting. No additional funding is required.

Captain J Bird

Division Commander

Household Cavalry Mounted Regiment

24 March 2026